RESEARCH & CREATIVE ACTIVITY

High-level Strategy for Achieving R1 at TCU

FACULTY SENATE
SEPTEMBER 25, 2025

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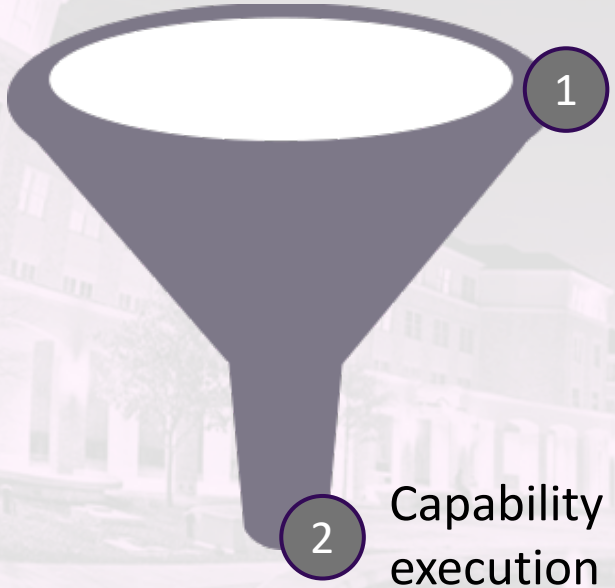
Keeping the Main Thing the Main Thing (the 3S's)

Why do we do it? Why are we here?

Widening the Funnel



1 Opportunity and funding

2 Capability and execution

Office of Research Purpose

- To **Strategize** with faculty and leadership
- To **Shape** opportunities for all faculty, researchers, and students
- To **Serve** ALL students, faculty, and staff at TCU along with the community and state

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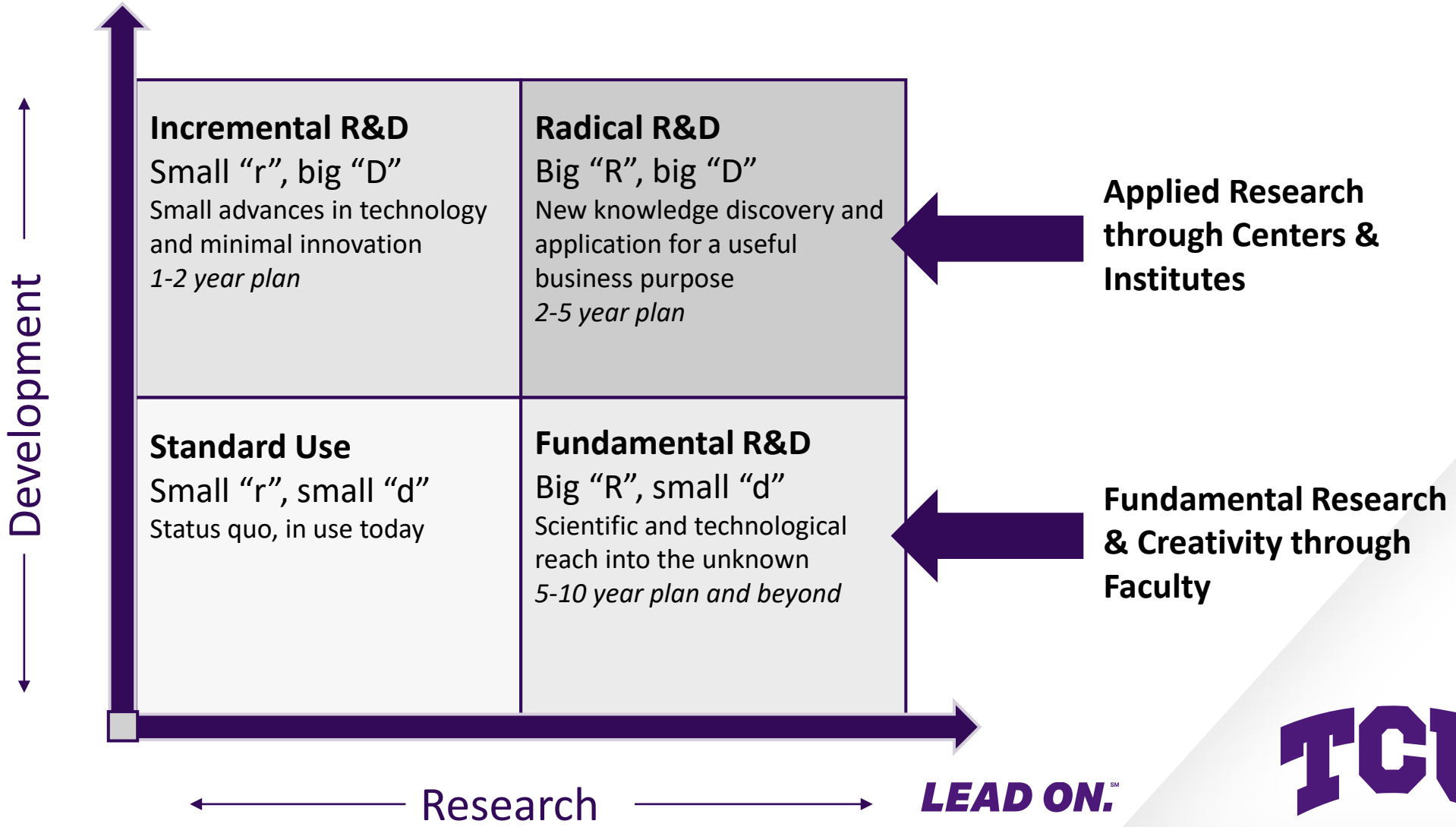
The Modern R1 Institution Runs at Two Speeds

Multimodal capability to operate with a sense of urgency while continuing to generate new knowledge.



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Repeatable Strategy for Building Programs

Forever money is the goal; highly functional interdisciplinary research teams are the pathway.

Taking basic R&D strategies from Industry for identifying an opportunity, designing an answer, and building a team to implement the solution:

Follow the Research & Development Methodology:

(1) Clearly identify customer requirements and define need; learn to speak the customer's language.
(2) Create solutions that either minimize customer pain points or provide customer opportunities.
(3) Build interdisciplinary teams that can successfully execute the solution.
(4) Build processes around the teams so that mistakes are mitigated, and time efficiencies are maximized.
(5) Teach the teams to think bigger than the original intent of the solution and the need it fills.
(6) Brand the teams, protect the solutions, and market the relationships with the customers.
(7) Demonstrate to future interdisciplinary teams the repeatability of this process with the partners and customer need.

STAGE 1: Become an output machine

STAGE 2: Become too big to mess with

STAGE 3: Become too big to fail

STAGE 4: Become the center of the universe

Startup to Sustainable: Moving from a new program into a long-term, self-sustaining program requires additional skills and a different process.

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Skating to Where the Puck is Going to Be

- AddRan College of Liberal Arts
- Anne Burnett Marion Schools of Medicine
- Bob Schieffer College of Communication
- Neeley School of Business
- College of Education
- College of Fine Arts
- College of Science & Engineering
- Harris College of Nursing & Health Sciences
- John V. Roach Honors College
- Mary Couts Burnett Library

TCU to Texas

Advanced Manufacturing & Materials

Hospitality, Tourism, & Culture

Petroleum Refining & Chemicals

Transportation & Logistics

Energy Evolution

Cyber Security & Information Technology

Professional Services & Corporate Operations

Food & Livestock Products

Life Sciences & Biotechnology

Rare Earth Elements & Mineral Mining

Texas to Federal

Artificial Intelligence

Quantum Computing

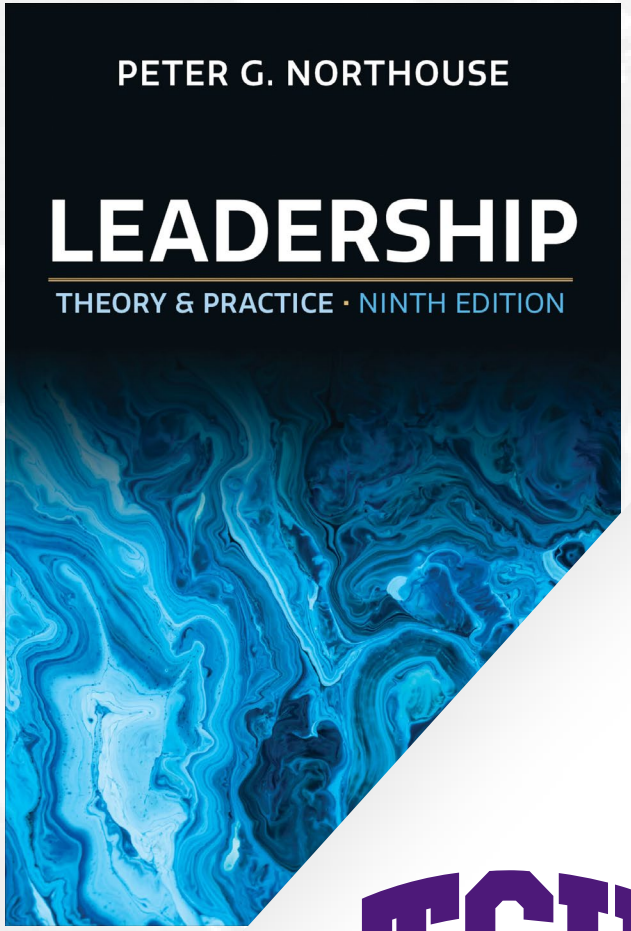
Space

Research Leadership U.

Creating the new R1 standard that drives university research leadership.

- Being a leader in research is different from being a leader of people.
- Becoming a leader is a process that doesn't require a title.
- **EVERYONE** should have competition-free, continuous access to leadership mentoring.

- To understand leadership is to first understand teams.



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